ARM Holdings (ARM): Results above the Street, with positive AGI CPU commentary but royalty miss

James Schneider, Ph.D.
+1(212)357-2929 | jim.schneider@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Anmol Makkar
+1(212)357-1366 | anmol.makkar@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Luya You
+1(212)902-5297 | luya.you@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Khalil Fenina
+1(212)357-6392 | khalil.fenina@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Liana Wadhwani
+1(212)357-3204 | liana.wadhwani@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Marshall Wong
+1(646)446-0222 | marshall.wong@gs.com
Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC

Key stock takeaways: We expect the stock to be range bound following headline revenue and EPS guidance that were above the Street. Key highlights from the quarter included stronger than expected Licensing revenue, offset by significantly lower Royalty revenues. Management noted increased confidence in achieving up to $2bn in AGI CPU customer demand. We believe investor expectations were relatively balanced heading into the quarter, given positive market sentiment for ARM's Datacenter CPU revenue ramp, offset by the recent selloff in the sector. On the positive side, management noted (1) sustained strength in Licensing with four new CSS customers in the quarter; (2) higher demand levels for its AGI CPU and increased confidence in achieving $2 bn in AGI CPU revenue in FY27-28. On the negative side, the company's royalty revenue again missed expectations, which we believe reflects near-term pressure in the smartphone market. We are Sell rated on ARM given our concerns around the near-term pressures in the royalty business, the lack of clear competitive advantage relative to peers in chip manufacturing, and elevated valuation relative to peers. However, we could consider being more constructive if we see greater evidence of an acceleration in royalty growth or more visibility into greater scale in chip manufacturing.

Quarterly results above the Street: ARM reported revenue of $1.44 bn, above GS at $1.39 bn and the Street (VA) at $1.38 bn, and operating margin of 44.2% was above GS at 42.2% and the Street at 41.6%. Operating EPS of $0.52 was above GS and the Street at $0.48. Licensing and other revenue of $773 mn was well above GS at $677 mn and the Street at $667 mn. Royalty revenue of $670 mn was well below GS at $707 mn and the Street at $708 mn.

- **AGI CPU demand:** Management noted that demand for ARM AGI CPUs has continued to strengthen, with purchase orders now secured from multiple customers and first commercial deliveries on track for FY4Q27. Importantly, confidence in achieving up to $2bn of ARM AGI CPU revenue across FY27-FY28 has increased over the past 90 days, supported by a broader customer mix and additional supply, while the company continues to expand capacity to address growing demand.
- **Licensing strength:** Licensing momentum remained strong, with license and other revenue rising 50% YoY to a record $773mn, ~$100mn above management expectations, driven by accelerating customer demand for long-term access to ARM technology. The company added three new ARM Total Access agreements,

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bringing active subscriptions above 60, including a first-time ATA agreement with a major customer, while also signing four new compute subsystem licenses across data center and smartphones.

- **Royalty miss, driven by smartphone weakness:** Royalty revenue of $670mn came in ~5% below GS/Street expectations, as strength in Cloud AI and Physical AI was more than offset by weakness in Edge AI, with higher memory pricing continuing to weigh on smartphone demand. Management expects these smartphone headwinds to persist near-term and guided to low-single-digit YoY royalty revenue growth in FY3Q (December).

FY3Q guidance is in line with the Street. ARM guided FY3Q revenue and operating EPS in line with the Street. Revenue was guided to $1.54 bn at the midpoint, which is in line with GS at $1.57 bn and the Street at $1.52 bn. Operating expense was guided to $825 mn, above GS at $811 mn and in line with the Street at $823 mn. Operating EPS guidance of $0.56 was below GS at $0.60 and in line with the Street at $0.55.

Estimate changes. We increase our EPS estimates by ~1% on average, driven by higher-than-expected Licensing and CPU silicon revenue, offset by lower Royalty revenue and lower gross margin assumptions (see detailed estimates in Exhibit 3).

Price target and risks: We are Sell rated on ARM. Our 12-month price target of $160 (unchanged) is based on a 50X our normalized EPS estimate of $3.20. Key upside risks: (1) stronger-than-expected datacenter ramp; (2) better-than-expected operating leverage; (3) better-than-expected execution on chip manufacturing.

Exhibit 1: ARM - Variance summary

Financials ($ mn, except EPS)	FY2Q27 Actual	GS	Street	Actual/GS	Actual/Street
Licensing Revenue	773	677	667	14.1%	15.8%
Royalty Revenue	670	707	708	-5.3%	-5.4%
Total Revenue	1,443	1,385	1,377	4.2%	4.8%
QoQ	*11.9%*	*7.4%*	*6.8%*		
YoY	*27.1%*	*22.0%*	*21.3%*		
Gross Margin (excl. SBC)	97.9%	98.6%	98.2%	*-74 bps*	*-31 bps*
Operating Income (excl. SBC)	638	584	573	9.3%	11.3%
Operating Margin (%)	44.2%	42.2%	41.6%	*+206 bps*	*+258 bps*
EPS (excl. SBC)	$0.52	$0.48	$0.48	7.4%	9.3%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

Exhibit 2: ARM - Guidance

Financials ($ mn, except EPS)	FY3Q27E Low	High	Guidance (midpoint)	GS	Street	Guidance/GS	Guidance/Street
Total Revenue	1,490	1,590	1,540	1,569	1,519	-1.8%	1.4%
QoQ			*6.7%*	*13.3%*	*10.4%*		
YoY			*24.0%*	*26.3%*	*22.3%*		
Operating expense (ex SBC)			825	811	823	1.7%	0.3%
EPS (excl. SBC)	0.52	0.6	0.56	$0.60	$0.55	-7.0%	1.9%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Visible Alpha Consensus Data

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Exhibit 3: ARM – Old vs. New estimates

Financials ($mn, except EPS)	FY2027E GS	FY2027E Old	FY2027E Δ	FY2028E GS	FY2028E Old	FY2028E Δ	FY2029E GS	FY2029E Old	FY2029E Δ
Licensing Revenue	3,137	2,965	+5.8%	3,556	3,297	+7.8%	3,911	3,606	+8.5%
Royalty Revenue	2,936	3,021	-2.8%	3,618	3,712	-2.5%	4,348	4,485	-3.1%
CPU Revenue	100	100		1,500	1,000	+50.0%	2,200	2,000	+10.0%
Total Revenue	6,173	6,086	+1.4%	8,674	8,010	+8.3%	10,458	10,091	+3.6%
YoY	*25.5%*	*23.7%*	*+176 bps*	*40.5%*	*31.6%*	*+892 bps*	*20.6%*	*26.0%*	*-542 bps*
Gross Margin (excl. SBC)	96.3%	96.7%	-44 bps	87.1%	90.9%	-382 bps	85.9%	87.0%	-114 bps
Operating Income (excl. SBC)	2,744	2,722	+0.8%	3,687	3,615	+2.0%	4,710	4,636	+1.6%
EPS (excl. SBC)	$2.26	$2.25	+0.5%	$3.00	$2.95	+1.7%	$3.80	$3.75	+1.3%

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Price target

PRICE TARGET AND RISK/REWARD SUMMARY				
Method	**Metric**	**Base**	**Bull**	**Bear**
P/E Method	Normalized EPS Estimate	**$3.20**	**$6.00**	**$2.50**
	Multiple	**50.0x**	**60.0x**	**35.0x**
	Valuation	**$160**	**$360**	**$88**
	Upside/Downside	**-15.3%**	**90.5%**	**-53.4%**
Price Target	**12-Month Price Target**	**$160**	100% P/E	
	Potential Upside/Downside	-15.3%		
	Dividend Yield at Current Price	0.0%		
	Potential Total Return	**-15.3%**		

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

ARM	12m Price Target: **$160.00**	Price: **$191.80**	Downside: **16.6%**

Sell

Market cap: $207.0bn
Enterprise value: $202.8bn
3m ADTV: $1.3bn
United States
Americas Semiconductors & IT Services
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue ($ mn) New	**4,920.0**	**6,172.7**	**8,673.9**	**10,458.1**
Revenue ($ mn) Old	4,920.0	6,086.2	8,009.5	10,090.8
EBITDA ($ mn)	2,364.0	3,061.8	4,011.2	5,033.8
EBIT ($ mn)	2,115.0	2,743.8	3,687.2	4,709.8
EPS ($) New	**1.77**	**2.26**	**3.00**	**3.80**
EPS ($) Old	1.77	2.25	2.95	3.75
P/E (X)	76.0	85.0	64.0	50.5
Dividend yield (%)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(1.2)	(1.3)	(1.5)	(1.8)

	9/26	12/26E	3/27E	6/27E
EPS ($)	0.52	0.57	0.72	0.67

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 4 Nov 2026 close.

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Contributing Authors: James Schneider, Ph.D. Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Anmol Makkar Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Luya You Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Khalil Fenina Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Liana Wadhwani Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC, Marshall Wong Goldman Sachs & Co. LLC.

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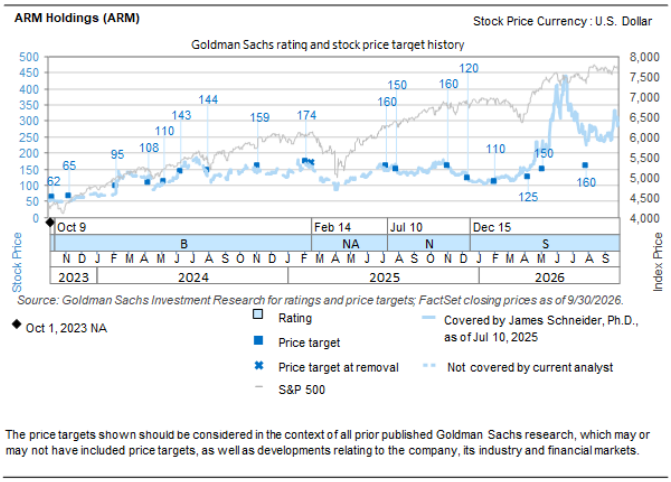
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ARM Holdings (ARM)

Date of report	Target price ($)	Closing price ($)
30-Jul-26	160.00	241.54
07-May-26	150.00	213.31
08-Apr-26	125.00	148.91
05-Feb-26	110.00	110.88
15-Dec-25	120.00	124.37
06-Nov-25	160.00	158.25
31-Jul-25	150.00	141.38
10-Jul-25	160.00	148.55
06-Feb-25	174.00	167.47
07-Nov-24	159.00	150.65
01-Aug-24	144.00	121.51
11-Jun-24	143.00	143.92
09-May-24	110.00	103.59
09-Apr-24	108.00	126.81
08-Feb-24	95.00	113.89
09-Nov-23	65.00	51.58

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